

FILM DOSSIER: THOR: THE HALLS OF HEL

Phase 4 · Film #6 (Saga Two, Film #6 · Overall Film #35)

Status:  DOSSIER COMPLETE (awaiting showrunner lock)

1. IDENTITY

Field	Entry
Film #	Saga Two #6 (Phase 4, Film #6) · MCU #35
Phase	Phase 4, The Secret Wars Saga
Real title	<i>THOR: THE HALLS OF HEL</i>
Decoy / codename title	<i>"BONE DRY"</i>
Release date	Friday, May 5, 2023
Distributor	Walt Disney Studios Motion Pictures
Director	Taika Waititi
Rating / runtime	PG-13 · 160 minutes
Genre + second genre	Superhero action-adventure + dark fantasy / journey into the underworld

2. OWNERSHIP

Field	Entry
Whose film / franchise is this?	ESTHER SMILLEY (Thor, film 4 of the franchise)

Character	Actor	Age at release
Thor, ruler of Asgard	Esther Smilley	40
Hela	Cate Blanchett	53
Skurge the Executioner	Karl Urban	50
Loki	Tom Hiddleston	42
Frigga	Rene Russo	69
Jane Foster	Natalie Portman	41
Heimdall / Sif	Idris Elba / Jaimie Alexander	50 / 39
Volstagg / Fandral / Hogun	Ray Stevenson / Zachary Levi / Tadanobu Asano	58 / 42 / 49
Beta Ray Bill	Terry Crews	54
Doctor Strange (cameo)	Benedict Cumberbatch	46
Mephisto (post-credit)	Ciarán Hinds	70

Real-history note (locked): Ray Stevenson died on May 21, 2023, sixteen days after this film opens. This is his last appearance as Volstagg, and the film is dedicated "In memory of Ray Stevenson." Under the Casting Rules, Volstagg is not recast. Any future Thor film will address his passing in-universe, with respect.

3. SOURCE MATERIAL (EARTH-616)

Field	Entry
Primary comic(s) adapted	Walter Simonson's <i>Thor</i> #360–362 (1985–86): Hela steals the souls of mortals . Thor, Balder and the Warriors Three go into Hel to take them back. Hela curses Thor so that he can't die but his bones will never heal . Skurge holds the bridge Gjallerbru alone against the armies of the dead, and dies.
Supporting comics	<i>Thor</i> #363–366 (1986, Thor fights on in armor, his bones shattered) · <i>Journey into Mystery</i> #102 (1964, Hela) · <i>Thor</i> #337 (Simonson, Beta Ray Bill)
Nerf check	☒ Hela is Asgard's goddess of death , the equal of Thor. Her curse breaks Thor's body , and Thor keeps fighting . Skurge's last stand is at full strength against thousands.

3A. COMIC ACCURACY REPORT

Field	Entry
Overall accuracy score	97% . Simonson's Hel arc, including Gjallerbru , which was promised in <i>Thor: The Twilight Sword</i> .

Straight from the page:

- **Hela takes mortal souls into Hel** (#360).
- **Thor** leads a war party into Hel: the **Warriors Three**, **Skurge**, and others (#360–361).
- **Hela curses Thor: he can't die, and his bones become brittle and never heal** (#361).
- **Skurge the Executioner** stays behind **alone at Gjallerbru**, the bridge out of Hel, with two M16 rifles, **holding back the armies of the dead** so the others can escape. "*He stood alone at Gjallerbru.*" (#362)
- **Thor** leaves Hel **wearing armor to hold her broken body together** (#362–363).

Changes and why:

| Change | Why |

|---|---|

| The **stolen souls come from the Great Society's destroyed Earth** (*The Black Priests*) | It ties the film to the Secret Wars Saga. Billions of dead souls flooded Hel, and Hela wants more. |

| **Doctor Strange** appears | His guilt: those souls are his doing |

POWERS & ABILITIES

Character	616 powers & abilities	Shown in this film	Held back (why)	Match
Thor	God-level strength; Mjolnir; the God Blast	Fights through Hel with broken bones , and her God Blast holds off Hela's army	The Odinfence (later)	 100%
Hela	The Asgardian goddess of death: death-touch, curses , command of the armies of the dead , near-invulnerable in Hel	The curse on Thor ; an army of the dead	–	 100%
Skurge	Near-Asgardian strength; his axe; two M16s	Holds Gjallerbru alone against thousands	–	 100%
Beta Ray Bill	Stormbreaker; class 100	Joins the war party	–	 100%

4. STORY

Field	Entry
Logline	Billions of souls from a murdered world flood the halls of Hel, and its queen wants more. To take back the dead, Thor has to walk into the underworld and pay with her own body.
Theme	Sacrifice and redemption. Skurge was a villain, and he dies a hero.
Villain / antagonist	Hela

What the movie is about

ACT ONE: THE FLOOD OF SOULS

- **Monday, January 16, 2023. Hel is overflowing** with billions of souls from the destroyed Great Society Earth.
- **Hela**, swollen with power, **starts taking mortal souls from Midgard** too, including children in a New York hospital.
- **Doctor Strange** comes to Asgard: *"Those souls in Hel are there because of me. Help me get them back."*

ACT TWO: INTO HEL

- **Thor** leads a war party into Hel: **Loki, Sif, the Warriors Three, Beta Ray Bill, and Skurge the Executioner**.
- **Hela** faces Thor and **curses her**: *"You shall never die, sister of storms. But your bones will never mend."*
- Thor's bones break with every blow, and she keeps going.

ACT THREE: GJALLERBRU

- They free the stolen souls and **run for Gjallerbru**, the only bridge out of Hel.
- The **armies of the dead** are coming.
- **Skurge** stops on the bridge and turns around, alone, with his axe and **two rifles from Midgard**.

SKURGE: *"Go. I'll hold them."*

- **He stood alone at Gjallerbru**.
- Thor comes back to Asgard **encased in armor** to hold her broken body together. The children in the hospital wake up.
- At Skurge's funeral, **Volstagg** says only: *"Aye. He stood alone."*

5. MCU TIMELINE PLACEMENT

Field	Entry
When it's set	Monday, January 16, 2023 → Monday, April 3, 2023.
Where it's set	Asgard · Hel (practical underworld sets and New Zealand locations) · Gjallerbru · New York (the hospital)
Relative to other films	Four months after <i>Kraven's Last Hunt</i>. Strange's guilt from <i>The Black Priests</i> is the reason the story starts.

6. WORLD-BUILDING

The film's own world

- **Thor in armor, cursed** and unbreakable.
- **Skurge's sacrifice**, and **Hela's defeat**.

World-building for the wider MCU

Seed	How it appears	Payoff
The cost of the Incursions	Billions of dead souls	Phase 5
Strange and Thor	Allied by guilt	Phase 5

Setting up the Big Bad (THE SECRET WARS SAGA)

Seed	How it appears	What it means
Mephisto's interest	The post-credit scene	Mephisto is collecting souls from dead universes. Doom's mother is among his hostages.

7. POST-CREDIT SCENES

Field	Entry
Mid-credit scene	✅ "ARMOR." Thor, in her new armor, tries to sit on the throne and can't bend . Loki laughs until he cries.
Post-credit scene	✅ "THE OTHER HELL." Mephisto's realm. The souls Hela lost drift into Mephisto's hands. He smiles. Cynthia von Doom , in chains, watches them arrive. MEPHISTO: <i>"More guests, Cynthia. Your boy's friends keep killing worlds. It's marvelous for business."</i> CUT TO BLACK. "THOR WILL RETURN."
Secret shoot codenames	Mid-credit: "POSTURE." Post-credit: "HOTEL CALIFORNIA."

CHECKLIST

- [x] Comic(s) adapted · [x] Comic Accuracy Report + powers · [x] Real and decoy titles · [x] What it's about · [x] Villain · [x] Post-credit scenes · [x] The film's own world-building · [x] MCU world-building

· [x] Big Bad setup · [x] Whose franchise · [x] When and where in the timeline